

Wilson Reading System®

# Student Reader Three



**FOURTH EDITION**

Wilson Language Training Corporation

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## The Best Lunch

Mom is hard at work with the bills for the month. She has to check each number and add everything up. Dad and Ellen think that Mom should stop and rest for a bit.

“Mom should not miss lunch. We cannot let that happen!” says Dad. “First, I will put the dishes out so we can have shrimp salad. Then, I will grab the can of shellfish from the top shelf and mix the shrimp into a salad.”

“I want to help,” says Ellen, “I will put out some napkins and glasses and I can also get the basket for the plum muffins.”

Ellen and her dad chitchat as they fix a very big lunch. When they finish and everything is set, they call Mom to come sit with them. When Mom comes in, she says, “What in the world have you two been up to?”

Ellen, Mom, and Dad have the shrimp salad with plum muffins and some cold milk. “This is the best lunch yet and now I am full,” says Mom, “Thanks for everything!”

## Tennis Until Sunset

Kevin gets his racket and a tennis ball from the front hall. The tennis ball has the number seven on it, and Kevin thinks this brings the best luck. Kevin then runs off with a rapid step, as he has plans to hang out with Justin until sunset.

Kevin jogs on the path. It is full of long branches and Kevin has to zigzag and push past them. He then runs uphill to get to the end of the path. He rushes as fast as he can, but Justin has gotten there first!

Kevin pulls the tennis ball out of his pocket and sends it to Justin with a very strong whack. Justin is quick and he has to jump up to hit the ball over the net. The two pals racket the ball to each other many times.

Now, Kevin gets hot as he runs and jumps, so he has to unzip his jacket. They both have so much fun, but at last the sun becomes dim. It is sunset, and they have to stop. Kevin and Justin must jog to get home quick.

## Chess Club?

At the end of math class, Mr. Sanchez asks Anton and Megan to hold on so he can have a word with them. When everyone exits the class, Anton and Megan go up to Mr. Sanchez's desk. He tells them that they are number one and two in his class. He thinks they should think about coming to check out the chess club.

Mr. Sanchez then tells them that he runs the club and that the kids in the club have six classes each month. Megan and Anton would not only have to commit to come to all the classes, but they would have fun. Mr. Sanchez does not push them, but he does ask that they think about it.

Anton and Megan go to the club the very next day to check things out. They can tell that the world of chess is all about habits and methods. There are a number of skills that one must work at to become good at chess. You must plan for each and every move.

Megan and Anton tell Mr. Sanchez that they do not want to be left out. Chess will be a test of their skills, but they are up for the task!

## **Snack or Script?**

Dennis went to go meet Meg on campus at seven p.m. He had asked Meg to get some hummus, chips, and a cold drink at the snack shop. When Dennis got to Meg's hall, she was candid with him and told him that she had to finish her work on a script. Meg said that she had to submit the text in class on the last day of the month. That was the very next day! She still had a lot of work to do and a number of things left to publish the script.

Meg then had a fit, "How did this happen? Why did I push this off?"

Dennis told Meg not to fret and that he could help. He did not want to witness her panic about this. Plus, he should hold off on the snacks for now.



First, Dennis would set up an index, then he had to jot down edits for the text. Next, Meg and Dennis had to save everything on her laptop. At last, the script was all set, but by then it was ten p.m. So, the two pals did not go out for a snack in the end, but Meg did have some lemon drops for them. They sat to rest and make new plans to visit the snack shop.

## A Trip to the Cabin

With a picnic basket in hand, Ed and Babs went to their rustic cabin. It was on the summit of a hill where everything was wild. The cabin sat in a sunlit glen with only a small number of steps to a hot spring.

When they got to the cabin, the first thing they did was go for a long dip in the hot spring. It felt grand to rest, gab, and slack off a bit. Next, they both hung out on the front deck and went on with their chat.

At about two p.m., a sudden, and random cold wind hit the canyon. Ed and Babs had to rush into the cabin to exit the chill. Babs put the picnic basket on the old chest. They had a lunch of crab legs, bran muffins, and lemon punch. They were so full!

At six p.m., they pushed a bench next to the glass to check out the vivid sunset. It was a thrill to see the sky becoming pink. Then, Babs and Ed had to go. They put their trash in a sack to bring back with them. Then they got the picnic basket and off they went. Ed and Babs shall come back to this spot to rest some more in about a month.

## **A Mess at the Banquet**

Beth wants to ask Evan to go with her to the big banquet next month, but every now and then Evan can be a bit of a slob. Beth thinks about this, yet she could not go to this shindig with anyone but Evan. He is still the best lad!

When Evan says yes, Beth is full of bliss. They go to the shop and get Evan a brand new linen top and some black pants.

The day of the banquet is here. With the number of people and all the racket, Evan does not put his napkin on his lap. All of a sudden, the lemon relish on top of the chicken falls onto the bottom of his linen

top. This misluck does not upset him, but Beth is sullen and fusses about it. She thinks that they cannot fix his top that had cost a lot.

Then Evan runs to get some tonic. First, he splashes the tonic on his top. Next, he rubs his napkin on the wet spot and off comes the lemon relish! Evan has pulled off a very grand trick. Then Evan, the comic, says to Beth, “You see, I have put my napkin to work after all!”

## The Running Contest

Ted plans to win the next running contest this month. Everyone thinks he will come in second again. Ted does not wish to be unkind, but he does not want Jim or Patrick to win another time. They have gotten so many medals in the past! Ted has been putting in a lot of work to invest in his skills.

Ted gets that he must run as quick as a rabbit to be the new number one. At the signal, he must dash off and sprint as fast as he can. Blast-off! Ted kicks off to get a jump on the others. After the children run over to the cliff, they must also bolt down to the fishpond and back.

At first, Ted is only in fifth place, but he does not panic. He has to pass Patrick and Jim at the cliff. All of a sudden, Ted pushes past Patrick, and then he zips by Jim. Ted is out in front of the pack as he rushes to the fishpond and back. Yes! He comes in first and now he is number one!

“It is a thrill to get credit for this win and put a medal around my neck at last,” says Ted.

## **A Picnic with a Chipmunk**

Kendrick pulled his new blanket out of the closet. Then, he got the picnic basket from the front hall. Kendrick had asked his friend, Brit, to go on a picnic with him down by the old windmill. Brit would bring the drinks and the sunblock, and Kendrick said he would come with the blanket and lunch.

Kendrick got to work putting all the food in the basket. First, he made two sandwiches and put them in the basket with some snacks. When the basket was full, Kendrick got his sunglasses from the shelf and set off.

When Kendrick pulled up to the spot next to the windmill, Brit was there with the lemon punch and sunblock. The two pals had to unfold the blanket, then



sit down to dig into their splendid lunch. After they ate the sandwiches, a very small chipmunk ran up to the blanket and sat down in front of the basket. Kendrick asked, “Where did you come from?”

The chipmunk just sat by the basket. He was intent on his plan to munch on their snacks. Brit got a pretzel from the basket and put it on the blanket. The chipmunk was quick to chomp and crunch until the pretzel was gone.

Kendrick said, “I see now that this was a picnic for three!”

## **Down by Six** PART ONE

The children in seventh grade are set for the class trip. They will attend the Wildcats game. A brand new bus pulls up. Does this impress the kids? Yes! They all yell as they think a trip on a new bus will be a thrill. With their backpacks in hand, they hop into the bus one by one.

It is a long trip to get to the lot where the bus can stop, but at last they are there. The kids cross the lot and hand their tickets to a man with the number seven on his hat. Then, they find their spots to sit.

In the first inning, there are no runs at all. One kid asks, “Should I take a nap?”

Will the second inning be another flop? No, the other team gets one hit after another. The Wildcats are now down by six. By the seventh inning, the fans in the stands are wild with panic. The next inning does not go well, with many missteps. The Wildcats have to attempt a big inning and get, at best, six runs.

## **Down by Six** PART TWO

It is now down to the last inning and the Wildcats are at bat. Whack! It is a solid hit to the left. At long last, the Wildcats have a man on base! Will they get another hit? With some luck, yes! Each swing must be big to set up the Wildcats for some runs. Can they come back and pull off a win?

The Wildcats must push and work for each hit. Justin swings the bat and gets a big hit. Two runs for the Wildcats!

The next swing of the bat ends with a pop-up hit and an out. Is their luck over? No, not yet. Bill gets hit by the ball and is sent to first base. On the next play,

he dashes to grab a spot on second. One Wildcat after another grabs a spot on base. The runs come in and it is now six to six.

The Wildcats now bring in their top new talent - Big Ed. He will pinch-hit. Then it happens - a rocket shot over the wall. It is a grand slam and the game is over. It is a big win for the Wildcats!

The kids in the stands insist that they come back for another Wildcats game on their next class trip!

## **Travel to the Tropics**

Have you been to the tropics? If you said no, then sit down and let me attempt to tell you why you should enlist for a visit now!

The tropics are a splendid spot on the planet, where the crimson sun glints from sunup to sunset. Sunglasses, hats, and sandals are a must to exist here.

The tranquil land of the tropics is rich with sun and sand. The winds are mild and a wet mist sets on this world under the sun. The hills and canyons consist of lush blossoms, plants, and grass. The wetlands are a kingdom full of frogs, bats, and rabbits. Do you want to stand next to one mammal after another? How about a sloth?

If after all of this, the tropics does not enchant or impress you, why not frolic and go for a swim in the gulf or trek on over to the inland thicket? Now, I cannot tell a fib. There can be a lot of bugs in the tropics and you must have a stash of sunblock. Yet, this windswept land we call the tropics should be number one on your list of new spots to stop!

## Problems at the Common PART ONE

The squall last month had hit the town common with gusts of wind and now everything was a mess. The town boss had to call Mr. Griffin as he did the best work with this kind of stuff. He told Mr. Griffin that there was cash in the bank, but he must get a bid to submit.

Mr. Griffin said he would come check out the mess in an instant. When Mr. Griffin got to the common, he could tell that it was a complex job. The sandlot to the left of the common was full of trash, and the swing set for the kids was a mess. One swing had split in two and another swing had a big dent in it. The posts on the swing set had cracks which could put the kids at risk. There were also two lampposts that were now under some branches.



Mr. Griffin first had to jot down all the numbers on a slip, and rush over to the town boss to hand in his bid. Still, Mr. Griffin would have to enlist help and must, at best, make a small profit. This mess would cost the town hundreds and hundreds in cash.

## Problems at the Common PART TWO

The boss told Mr. Griffin that the numbers would work, and that he could get to work on the common now. Mr. Griffin got his best staff to assist him with yet another job. With one quick text, Jill, Brock, and the others were on the job.

They all went in shifts to pick up the trash everywhere. Then they had to drag the fallen branches and push them into a big truck. After that, they had to install new posts under the swing set and attach new swings for the kids. The lampposts got a fix with some new straps and bolts. Glass panels were put over the backs and tops of the lamps.

At the end of the job, the town boss saw the contrast. The common was back to its old self. He said, “Mr. Griffin, you impress me!”

## Craft Class

Mrs. Waters instructs a craft class every Monday. The word has gotten out that this class is the best. In fact, the talk in the town is nonstop. So many children now attend, that the class list is full!

In class, each kid gets to grab a bunch of stuff to make their very own craft. There are baskets and buckets full of objects to pick for each project; bits of glass and metal, scraps of fabric, pens, string, felt... everything you can think of!

Nelson and Alex walk to Mrs. Waters' class. The class is at three o'clock on the dot and she insists that the kids be prompt. Nelson and Alex are quick to grab a spot right in front.

Mrs. Waters tells the kids about their new craft project. They will make puppets! The class goes wild.

Next, Mrs. Waters passes out a sock to each kid. Then, they are off to collect all the stuff they wish to use to construct their very own puppet. Nelson is quick to run to the buckets with the string, pom-poms, and ink pens. Alex dashes to the baskets to get scraps of fabric, stamps, and some plastic shells.

The kids work fast to finish the project. They know that Mrs. Waters will let them try out their puppets!

## **The Trash Can Suspect**

Mrs. Griffin goes out to add a bag to her trash can. The rubbish truck will be there by six to collect the trash. When she gets to the top step, she sees that everything is a mess. The trash can has been pushed down and there is trash everywhere. A mass of insects, in fact hundreds of them, walks over the trash.

Mrs. Griffin says “What in the world? This is not right!”

Mrs. Griffin thinks to herself, “After I pick up this mess, I will get to the bottom of this. I will try to track down a suspect. I wish I knew the facts!”

Mrs. Griffin gets some new bags and puts all the trash back in its right spot. Then, she gets some water to splash on the spot that was a mess.

Now, Mrs. Griffin must find out who knew about this act. She walks a few steps to get to Mr. Brock's. Did he see this trash can suspect?

Mrs. Griffin has no luck from her talk with Mr. Brock. He tells her, "I do not know about your trash. I was in bed and did not see anything."

Mrs. Griffin is at a loss. Who would bring about this kind of conflict? Who should she contact next?

All of a sudden, the suspect springs out from under the deck. It is a big skunk! Mrs. Griffin said, "Well, I must admit, I did not expect this!"

## Collect Some Bugs

Mr. Wong will help Ross get set up to collect bugs. He has the talent and skills to put Ross on the right track with this new trend. Mr. Wong collects many kinds of insects, so he knows a lot about this subject. Ross suspects Mr. Wong is the best one to instruct him.

Mr. Wong says, “Let’s go have a look at my bug closet!” Ross asks, “Do you really have a closet full of bugs?”

“That’s right! Let’s walk there and we can talk about insects,” said Mr. Wong.

Ross is in shock when they get to Mr. Wong's bug closet. There are hundreds of insects to see and discuss. Some bugs are in boxes and some are in glass panels, but Mr. Wong tells Ross that he lets most of them back into the wild.

Ross says, "I did not expect this! It must be a big project to collect all these bugs. How do you do it?"

Mr. Wong says, "First, you get a bug net and a glass jug. Then you go out for an insect hunt!"

Mr. Wong tells Ross he should bring a pad and pen too. Ross can write down what he finds, then let the insects go.



## **Mrs. Dunlop and her Bills**

Fred has to assist his mom, Mrs. Dunlop, with her bills from the past month. Each day, Mrs. Dunlop collects her bills and tosses them all into one box. As you would expect, her bills and checks are now in such a big mess!

Mrs. Dunlop does not subtract the cash when she spends it. She knows that this is a bad habit to not do the exact math. Still, she does not write anything down. The impact of all of this is that now Mrs. Dunlop has spent more cash than she has in the bank!

Mrs. Dunlop does not object to his help, so Fred gets to work to fix this mess. It is a big project to inspect each bill. He checks each number twice so he can get everything right. Then, he has to write out all the bills and get some stamps.

After the bills are intact, Fred has a talk with his mom, and she tells him that she does not intend to let this happen again.

## **Alan's Work in the Lab**

Everyone thinks Alan's job at the lab must be dull. The fact is - it's not! The tasks can be long to finish, but Alan relishes this hands-on work.

Each month, Alan collects gallons of water from wells and ponds. It is his job to then bring the water back to the lab to test it. There, the staff inspects the water to see if any toxins exist. The lab insists on the best methods which are complex. What they find out about the water makes a big impact.

Alan puts the water he collects in flasks. Then he injects the water with a solvent and gives it a strong mix. Alan conducts this test over and over so he can attest that the numbers are exact. This month the water tests are good. The public will know that the water is all right to fish and swim without any problems.

## The Atlantic

The Atlantic is so big and vast! In fact, it is the second biggest ocean in the world. Most of the Atlantic is cold, but some is in the subtropics and hot! The strong Atlantic winds can affect the lands right next to the water. These winds can also be a problem for transatlantic trips.

The Atlantic is not as it was back in the day. In the past, it was the best spot for fishing, but now there are not as many wild fish in the Atlantic. Fish are a common dish, so they are at risk and may vanish. But, there is a fix for this problem - people need to be strict and not overfish.

Trash and toxins in the Atlantic are another big problem. The trash and toxins in the water can be found all over the world. Why is this bad? Some Atlantic mammals get very sick from all this rubbish.

Also, there are fishing nets that get left in the Atlantic waters. These nets can imprison and kill the mammals and then their numbers drop. It is sad, but we can all help to remove the junk from the water. We can collect our nets and put our trash away. What do you say? Let's all plan to help the fantastic Atlantic today!

## **The Fantastic Hamilton**

Hamilton attends class in Wisconsin, but he is from Manhattan. He gets sad when he thinks of all the people he misses back home. Hamilton's mom, dad, and all his pals are still in Manhattan.

Every six months or so, his mom and dad come for a visit. During their visits, Hamilton, Mom, and Dad get to spend two days with each other. Hamilton is always glad for the visits and for a split second, he wishes to go back to Manhattan. But, Hamilton does not go. He has so much to accomplish and is set to attempt to do his best in this class. He will go back to be with everyone at Thanksgiving, anyway. For now, he has a big job to do.

Hamilton works with other kids in the class to bring wildcats back to the spots they inhabit. It is sad, but people hunt these cats for their fur. It may not be the most distinct fur. It is not soft or grand, but Hamilton does not want it sold as a product in the shops.

Hamilton is fond of wildcats and all mammals. He does not want any of them to vanish from the world. That is why he will not stop until the cats are safe. No one can discredit Hamilton. He may be a long way from home right now, but he is fantastic!

## The Fossil Exhibit

Ingrid has a splendid plan for the day. She has had this plan for a month now. She is on her way to visit the fossil exhibit in Wilmington. She is ecstatic about it, and cannot get the grin off her lips!

Ingrid will be the first one at the exhibit. Ingrid knew it would take over an hour to walk through the exhibit. So, she took the day off from work. Her boss, the congressman, did not get mad or admonish her one bit. He was glad to let Ingrid have some time off from her job.

The exhibit is just a quick walk away. When Ingrid gets there, she is not the first. The exhibit hall is full of people! She gets pushed and pulled a lot, but she is



not upset or indignant at all. She makes her way to the new kinesthetic fossil exhibit where she can put her hands on the exotic rocks and shells. It is fantastic!

After she witnesses everything in the fossil show, she goes to another exhibit which is about the lost land of Atlantis. To finish up the day, Ingrid has lunch on a bench in the common. There are snapdragons everywhere! When she gets back to her job the next day, she is quick to recommend the exhibit to all her pals and her boss.

## The Rafting Trip

Frank and Jill are planning a big rafting trip with many of their friends. They are all buzzing about how great it is going to be!

First, they will set up the tents and do some grilling when they get to the camp. Then they will be munching away on hot dogs, snacking on chips, and drinking lots of pop.

For fun, they will spend hour after hour splashing in the water, shellfishing in the sand, and sprinting over the hills. The dogs will be sniffing everything by the banks of the river.

On the second day at camp, the friends will set off on the rafting trip. It is going to be fantastic! People will be spilling out of the rafts and into the water, but it will be so thrilling! The friends will bump each other over as the rafts crash into the swift rapids.

When they make it through the rapids, they will drift on the still water, resting and unwinding as the sun sets.

Frank, Jill, and their friends are wishing the trip was today, but it is not for another month. One thing is for sure, it will be great.

## Walking and Talking

Angus and Jazmin could get on the bus to go to school, but they insist on walking every day. They are best friends, and they both want to walk and talk.

Each day their chat is on a new topic. They often talk about their classes, but today, Jazmin asks Angus to tell her about his plans for when school gets out. Angus jumps right into this subject. He tells Jazmin that he wants to spend each day hunting for frogs down by the pond and golfing with his dad.

Jazmin then tells her friend that she plans on attending an acting class. She wants to be cast in a film someday. Her mom called last month to get her on the acting class list. Angus thinks this is a great plan. Jazmin could be a talented actress.

In no time at all, they have landed at the front of the school. It's time to end their chat and get to work on their math and other subjects.

## **Invest More, Spend Less**

Ellen had to get solvent with her funds and assets fast. She was always spending her cash. Often at shops, she would go through her money in an instant. This was affecting her credit, and if Ellen did not stop this bad habit, she would be bankrupt!

Ellen knew she must establish a solid plan to invest her funds. In fact, she had intended to do this for a long time, but she just kept spending on a whim. Her husband, Frank, now insisted that she shift her mindset and get things back on track right away.

At last, Ellen called her friend, Mrs. Rush, at the bank. They both sat down and drafted a plan for the long run.

Mrs. Rush had recommended stashing most of her money from work in the bank. Now, Ellen had a solid method to hold on to her cash.

Ellen was ecstatic about her new plan. After thanking Mrs. Rush for helping her, she exited the bank in a flash. She wanted to tell Frank all about it. She knew he would think it was great!

## Passing a Bill

Passing a bill in Congress is very complex. There are a number of steps, and every aspect of a bill is inspected. Hundreds of people work to help with the passing of just one bill.

Congress starts by collecting all the facts and then editing the text. They spend a lot of time checking the cost and discussing what is intended with each new bill. Often, the talk can go on throughout many months. Then, it is put into a transcript, publishing it for the press and the public to see.

At long last, a bill can be called up for a vote. Everyone in Congress can now cast their ballot. If most of them think it is great and say yes, then the bill will pass through.